TOPIC REPORTS: DIGITAL IDENTITY AND CRVS

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News, Sep – Oct 2026

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Algeria

ISSUANCE TIMES FOR BIOMETRIC DRIVING LICENCES AND PASSPORTS

- **Permis et passeports biométriques : les délais de délivrance pénalisent les citoyens** — Maghreb Émergent, 1 October 2026

  Applicants in Algiers and Béjaïa reported waiting at least three months, and in some cases five to six, for biometric driving licences, and six to eight weeks for biometric passports. The interior ministry says applicants are notified by SMS when a licence is ready and can track requests online. No official explanation for the delays has been published.

UNIFIED NATIONAL DIGITAL IDENTITY

- **الكشف عن تفاصيل تقنية جديدة حول منظومة الهوية الرقمية وحماية البيانات** — PrixAlgerie News, 9 October 2026

  Algeria's digitalisation commission set out how the national digital identity is obtained: registration and an appointment at the commune, activation, then verification against biometric data. It also said a national data-governance system that classifies data sources against one reference is under way.

Angola

ANGOLAID PRIVATE IDENTITY WALLET

- **Tech By Tech disponibiliza versão de testes do AngolaID** — PTI, 9 October 2026

  Angolan company Tech By Tech released a test version of AngolaID, a private digital identity wallet and verification service, on Google Play and the App Store, announced on 7 October 2026. Users create a credential by video liveness check and facial recognition, and institutions can integrate it by API and SDK. The company says it does not issue or replace the state identity card.

Benin

SUSTAINABILITY MODEL FOR THE DIGITAL IDENTITY SYSTEM

- **Le Bénin recherche un expert international pour renforcer son système d'identité numérique** — wearetech.africa, 2 September 2026

Benin's ANIP, through the World Bank-financed WURI programme, called for expressions of interest in an international expert on digital public infrastructure strategy, to define a sustainable economic model and institutional framework for the identification agency. The 60-day mission spread over five months covers a strategic diagnosis, a comparison of international DPI and national identity models, and a roadmap for financing, operation, maintenance and modernisation. Applications closed 8 September 2026. The question being asked is how a national ID agency pays for itself once the donor project ends.

ONLINE RENEWAL OF THE BIOMETRIC NATIONAL IDENTITY CARD

- **Bénin : la carte d'identité biométrique peut désormais être renouvelée en ligne** — Bénin Web TV, 18 September 2026

  Benin's identification agency opened online renewal of the biometric identity card to all holders on International Identity Day, through its e-services platform. The procedure is started online but not fully automatic.

BIOMETRIC PROOF OF LIFE FOR PENSIONERS

- **Digitalisation de la preuve de vie : Le Ministère de l'Économie et des Finances simplifie la démarche** — Gouvernement de la République du Bénin, 3 October 2026

  Benin's Ministry of Economy and Finance announced on 3 October 2026 that pensioners can complete their annual proof of life from a smartphone. After identifying with their personal identification number (NPI) and pension booklet number, they verify their fingerprints in an app and receive confirmation by SMS or email. Biometric kiosks in some public places offer an alternative.

- **Benin launches app letting public-sector retirees provide proof of life remotely** — Ecofin Agency, 17 October 2026

  Benin launched Preuve de Vie on 15 October 2026, a mobile app through which public-sector pensioners of the FNRB confirm they are alive using their NPI, pension booklet number and fingerprint, from Benin or abroad. Biometric kiosks taking the national ID card are an alternative, and the campaign runs to 15 November 2026.

Burkina Faso

AES BIOMETRIC IDENTITY CARD ISSUANCE

- **Carte d'identité biométrique AES : les opérations d'établissement lancées à Koudougou** — Sidwaya, 9 September 2026

  Burkina Faso's national identification office ONI began special operations to issue the Alliance of Sahel States biometric identity card, CIB-AES, at Koudougou on 9 September 2026, ahead of International Identity Day on 16 September. No enrolment figures or costs are given.

- **ID Day 2026 : l'ONI ouvre plusieurs sites d'enrôlement à Ouagadougou face à l'affluence pour la CIB-AES** — FasoAmazone, 15 September 2026

  Burkina Faso's national identification office opened nine extra enrolment sites across Ouagadougou for the Sahel alliance biometric identity card after heavy demand at its main centre. Cards are promised within 48 hours during the special operation, which runs to International Identity Day on 16 September; no enrolment figures are given.

- **Burkina Faso : Désormais, la Gendarmerie nationale produit les CIB-AES et légalise les documents administratifs** — Aconews, 16 October 2026

Burkina Faso's territorial gendarmerie brigades may now issue the AES biometric identity card (CIB-AES) and certify administrative documents. Enrolment still requires a birth-certificate extract or nationality certificate.

AES BIOMETRIC PASSPORT

- **Passeports biométriques : le centre d'enrôlement de Ziniaré opérationnel** — Sidwaya, 14 October 2026

  Burkina Faso's Security Ministry opened biometric passport enrolment at the regional police directorate in Ziniaré on 13 October, part of extending mobile enrolment kits to every region. Applicants no longer need to travel to Ouagadougou or Bobo-Dioulasso; the AES passport costs 50,000 FCFA and takes two weeks.

Cameroon

YOUTH BIOMETRIC CARD AND EMPLOYMENT PLATFORM

- **Cameroun : le MINJEC et Nera Pulse en accord pour digitaliser l'insertion professionnelle des jeunes** — Journalducameroun.com, 15 September 2026

  The youth ministry signed a three-year renewable partnership with a company on 14 September to digitise, unify and speed access to employment and training for 15- to 35-year-olds, across six areas including socio-economic integration.

AIGLES BIOMETRIC PAYROLL SYSTEM

- **AIGLES AT E-GOVA: CAMEROON'S ANSWER TO A PAPERLESS AND CASHLESS AFRICA** — Ministry of Public Service and Administrative Reform (MINFOPRA), Cameroon, 16 October 2026

  Cameroon's public service minister Joseph LE presented AIGLES, the state personnel and payroll system, at the E-GOVA Africa summit in Yaoundé on 15 October 2026. He said it is over 80% deployed and handles recruitment, careers, promotion, retirement and pay for more than 250,000 civil servants.

- **Digitalisation : e-Gov Africa mise sur l'IA pour moderniser les services publics** — Le quotidien L'Economie, 16 October 2026

  At the first e-Gov Africa Summit in Yaoundé, Cameroon's public service ministry reported that its AIGLE staff and payroll platform has processed over 342,049 promotion and tenure acts automatically since January 2025. It cited over 6.4 million logins, over 3 million payslip notifications and secure e-signature in 37 of 40 administrations.

Chad

NATIONAL IDENTIFICATION ENROLMENT TOTAL AND COVERAGE RATE

- **ANATS — Agence Nationale des Titres Sécurisés, site officiel** — Agence Nationale des Titres Sécurisés (ANATS), République du Tchad, 2 September 2026

  Chad's secure documents agency, ANATS, set up by Ordinance 001/PR/2016, issues identity cards, passports, residence cards, driving licences and civil status records. Its website says its population management system assigns everyone enrolled, including refugees and foreign residents, a unique national identification number (NNI) after deduplication, and lists 29 enrolment centres. The page carries no date.

Cote d'Ivoire

NATIONAL AUTHENTICATION PLATFORM AND DIGITAL IDENTITY WALLET FEASIBILITY STUDY

- **Côte d'Ivoire-AIP/ Le Gouvernement mise sur le PARAE pour renforcer la confiance dans les services publics numériques** — AIP - Agence Ivoirienne de Presse, 5 October 2026

Côte d'Ivoire launched a feasibility study on 5 October 2026 for a national digital authentication platform and digital identity access point, under the e-administration support project PARAE, co-financed by the African Development Bank. The national identity office, ONECI, carries the project on the basis of the national population register. The study is due by January 2027.

- **La Côte d'Ivoire prépare une plateforme nationale d'authentification et un portefeuille d'identité numérique** — Startup Medias, 5 October 2026

  Côte d'Ivoire launched a feasibility study in Abidjan on 5 October 2026 for a national authentication platform and digital identity wallet, run by the PARAE project with African Development Bank support. The study will first assess existing assets, including the national population register and ONECI systems, and may extend to verifying digital credentials such as diplomas and permits. No cost or timetable is given.

DR Congo

BIOMETRIC PASSPORT

- **Semlex to face criminal trial in Belgium over Congo passport scandal** — Biometric Update, 1 September 2026

  Fourteen defendants in the case of Semlex, the Belgian firm that made the Democratic Republic of Congo's biometric passports from 2015 to 2025, have been sent to a Brussels criminal court on bribery, money laundering and tax fraud charges. Investigators allege about $60 of each $185 passport went to a Dubai firm, nearly $60 million in all; 51 Congolese citizens are civil parties.

- **RDC: Jean-Claude Mputu dénonce la continuité Semlex-RAM** — CongoQuotidien, 2 September 2026

  Jean-Claude Mputu, spokesman for the Congo Is Not For Sale coalition (CNPAV), said the Democratic Republic of Congo's passport contract with Semlex, renewed in 2020 when the original five-year deal expired, has never been published. The renewal, meant to last a year, ran until 2025; the only concession won was a passport price cut from $185 to $100.

DIASPORA DIGITAL IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **Diaspora congolaise : lancement à Paris et Bruxelles de la phase pilote de l'identification numérique** — B-one télévision, 30 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's minister delegate for the diaspora, Crispin Mbadu Phanzu, launched a pilot of digital identification for Congolese abroad at the embassy in Paris on 27 September 2026, and presented the registration platform diaspora.gouv.cd in Brussels two days later. Registrants record their education, specialisms and intended contributions. Extension to other missions is planned, with no dates given.

NATIONAL POPULATION IDENTIFICATION OPERATION

- **RDC : l'identification de la population annoncée pour la mi-décembre 2026** — Opinion Info, 12 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of the Congo plans to start national population identification in mid-December 2026, the 98th Council of Ministers heard from interior minister Jacquemain Shabani. The national population identification office, ONIP, will run the operation. The government said funding expected from partners and ONIP's own capacity could affect the timetable. No cost is given.

- **RDC : ce qu'il faut retenir de l'identification de la population et du recensement général de la population** — Beto.cd, 13 September 2026

The Democratic Republic of Congo's Council of Ministers, in a report read on 11 September 2026, set mass identification by the identity office ONIP to begin in December 2026 and the second general census to be enumerated in 2027. The two exercises fall under different ministries and budgets. The data protection authority has not yet been installed.

RDC-PASS NATIONAL DIGITAL IDENTITY PLATFORM

- **RDC : plus de 9 000 candidats pour RDC Pass** — Digital Business Africa, 14 September 2026

  DR Congo's digital economy ministry said more than 9,000 candidates sat the recruitment test for RDC Pass agents and a first cohort of 50 was retained for the Kinshasa pilot. Training starts on 15 September, followed by extension to other Kinshasa zones and then nationwide.

- **RDC-Pass : lancement de la formation des 50 premiers agents d'enregistrement** — 7sur7.cd, 16 September 2026

  DR Congo began training the first 50 enrolment agents for its RDC-Pass digital identity platform on 15 September 2026, three months after its launch. The digital economy minister said RDC-Pass is an authentication tool, not a national identity card, and does not replace civil registration.

- **RDC : le projet d'identification numérique RDC-Pass entre dans sa phase opérationnelle** — wearetech.africa, 17 September 2026

  The Democratic Republic of Congo's RDC-Pass digital identity project entered its first implementation phase three months after launch, with training for 50 registration agents opening in Kinshasa on 15 September. The identifier is intended to work across several administrations and reduce the number of separate identification systems.

POPULATION IDENTIFICATION ROADMAP

- **RDC : l'ONIP réaffirme son engagement en faveur d'un système national sécurisé d'identification** — Agence Congolaise de Presse (ACP), 17 September 2026

  DR Congo's national population identification office (ONIP) said on International Identity Day, 16 September 2026, that preparations for the national identification system are complete and data collection will start in December 2026, as a step towards a general population register. It said data security, privacy and transparency must be guaranteed as identification systems become interconnected.

Egypt

TELECOM EGYPT ELECTRONIC CUSTOMER IDENTIFICATION FOR LINE SALES

- **«وي» تطلق خدمة التحقق الإلكتروني من هوية العملاء (E-KYC)** — Youm7, 12 September 2026

  Telecom Egypt's mobile brand WE launched an electronic know-your-customer service that lets customers verify their identity, sign electronically and buy and activate lines without paper documents. The first phase covers individual mobile lines and some other digital services. The company says the service meets regulatory and data-protection requirements, without naming the identity database used.

REMOTE BIOMETRIC IDENTITY VERIFICATION AND E-SIGNATURE PLATFORM

- **إطلاق منظومة التحقق البيومتري الإلكتروني (الهوية الرقمية) لتيسير حصول المواطنين على الخدمات الرقمية عن بُعد** — Elmydan News, 18 September 2026

Egypt's communications and interior ministries launched a platform for remote biometric identity verification and electronic signature, which licensed telecom operators can offer inside their own smartphone applications so users need not visit a branch. It was built by the telecom regulator with the IT industry development agency, a local developer and licensed signature providers; no user count or list of relying services is given.

Equatorial Guinea

MODERNISATION OF THE DOCUMENT CENTRE'S IDENTITY AND PASSPORT TECHNOLOGY

- **El Vicepresidente de la República impulsa la modernización del sistema informático de CNEDOGE** — guineaecuatorialpress.com, 16 October 2026

  Equatorial Guinea's Vice-President Nguema Obiang Mangue authorised an upgrade of the systems at CNEDOGE, which issues identity cards and passports, after a report that much of its equipment dates from 2017-2018. Officials are to assess the installation with the supplier CETIS and cost the work, and CETIS was asked for new card and passport designs.

Eswatini

IDENTITY CARD AND PASSPORT PROCESSING AT HOME AFFAIRS

- **Network blackout strikes Home Affairs, EPTC** — Times of Eswatini, 16 September 2026

  A network outage on 16 September 2026 halted all identity card and passport processing at Eswatini's Home Affairs headquarters in Mbabane and at postal counters, with no restoration time given. Pupils needing original ID cards to sit examinations that week were among those turned away.

NATIONAL IDENTITY CARD

- **'Cat' Matlala wife arrest reignites Eswatini ID saga** — Independent News Eswatini, 23 September 2026

  Eswatini's Civil Service Commission found in September 2026 that suspended Home Affairs assistant registrar Nonhlanhla Malambe unlawfully issued a birth certificate and national ID card to a foreign national registered as 'Vusimuzi Dlamini', using an innocent citizen's details. The documents were issued in February 2024 and are allegedly used by South African businessman Vusimuzi 'Cat' Matlala; criminal proceedings continue.

Ethiopia

FAYDA NATIONAL DIGITAL IDENTITY

- **Ethiopia Announces Document Requirements for Foreign Nationals Applying for Fayda Digital ID** — Ethio Affairs, 4 September 2026

  Ethiopia has set out the documents foreign nationals must show to register for the Fayda digital ID: a passport with an Ethiopian Origin ID, residence or work permit, or investment licence, a refugee ID for refugees, and a foreign ministry ID for diplomats and international organisation staff. The requirements' issue date is not stated.

- **Fayda — 33 Proof of Acceptable Documents** — National ID Program (NIDP), Ethiopia, 7 September 2026

  The national identity programme's own page lists the 33 documents accepted as proof of identity for registration, from the local administration card and passport to birth, education, marriage and business records. The page carries no publication date of its own.

- **Ethiopia launches developer sandbox to support Fayda digital ID innovation, integration** — Biometric Update, 9 October 2026

Ethiopia opened a public sandbox where developers and startups can test the Fayda digital identity's authentication interfaces before going live. Fayda counted more than 52 million registrations, 150 integrated partners and 208 million electronic verifications.

FAYDAVERSE DIGITAL PUBLIC INFRASTRUCTURE ENTERPRISE

- **Banks Baulk at a Bill from Public ID That Turns Commercial** — Addis Fortune, 3 October 2026

  FaydaVerse, the new state enterprise running Ethiopia's Fayda digital ID, has begun charging banks for identity checks they once got free: 10 to 20 birr per KYC record retrieval and 20 to 40 birr per biometric authentication, by volume. Its contract bars banks from passing the cost to customers and bills failed attempts; the Ethiopian Bankers Association has asked for a joint consultation with the central bank.

Gabon

CITIZENSHIP AND SOCIAL PROTECTION REGISTRATION PROGRAMME

- **Gabon : la directrice générale de la Prévoyance Sociale s'enquiert du déroulement du Programme « Citoyenneté et Protection Sociale » à Mouila** — Agence Gabonaise de Presse (AGP), 2 September 2026

  Gabon's director general of social welfare visited Mouila on 1 September 2026 to review a programme issuing birth certificates to people without civil status and enrolling them in the national health insurance fund, CNAMGS. Across Ngounié province 500 files were registered, 486 sent to the Mouila court for substitute judgments, and 100 birth certificates are ready for collection.

BIOMETRIC BUS TRANSPORT CARD

- **Bus à Libreville : la CNT prépare la carte de transport biométrique** — GabonReview, 6 September 2026

  Gabon's national transport company, CNT, is preparing a personalised biometric card for Libreville buses and has consulted the data protection authority on the rules for collecting passengers' personal data, reported on 6 September 2026. The cards could be tailored to pupils, students and workers. No launch date or cost is given.

DIGITALISED DRIVING LICENCE

- **Permis de conduire digitalisé : l'enrôlement suspendu, près de 7 000 cartes disponibles à Libreville** — GabonReview, 21 September 2026

  Gabon's transport minister Ulrich Manfoumbi Manfoumbi suspended enrolment for the digitalised driving licence on 21 September 2026, six months after launch, to review the scheme; no resumption date was given. 6,993 printed licences await collection in Libreville, and unnamed sources linked the pause to production problems under heavy demand and power cuts.

- **Permis de conduire digitalisé : Avec l'appui de Gabon Poste, Rengus Digital dispose désormais d'une architecture technique plus puissante** — Gabonactu.com, 2 October 2026

  Rengus Digital, which runs Gabon's digitised driving licence launched on 24 March 2026, has moved the system onto Gabon Poste's infrastructure under a new agreement. Hosting capacity rises from about 1 terabyte at launch to about 10, after enrolment and issuing delays. The postal network is to support a rollout beyond Libreville, for which no dates are given.

Gambia

IDENTITY RECORDS OF THE FORMER SEMLEX BIOMETRIC ID SYSTEM

- **GID tells court it cannot access Semlex ID data** — Daily Observer (Gambia), 6 October 2026

A Gambia Immigration Department officer told a court on 6 October that the department can no longer reach data generated under the former Semlex biometric ID system, its access having ended with the contract. That leaves open who holds the historical identity records, although Semlex says it handed the system to the government in March 2024.

- **GID denies losing access to National ID card data** — Gambiana, 13 October 2026

  The Gambia Immigration Department denied losing access to national identity card data, saying the servers used under the former contract remain in the country. It attributed the reports to a misunderstanding of an officer's court testimony.

Ghana

GHANA CARD AS SOLE BANKING IDENTITY

- **Use of Ghana Card for All Financial Transactions** — Bank of Ghana, 2 September 2026

  The Bank of Ghana's website carries its directive, issued under the National Identity Register regulations (L.I. 2111), that from 1 July 2022 the Ghana Card is the only identity card accepted for transactions at institutions it licenses and regulates. The page is dated 2 September 2026 but the directive itself dates from 2022.

GHANA CARD ELECTRONIC WALLET

- **Ghana Card to become e-wallet for electronic transactions soon – NIA Boss** — Modern Ghana, 17 September 2026

  Ghana's National Identification Authority is in the final stages of making the Ghana Card an electronic wallet, secured by biometrics and a PIN, for transfers to and from bank accounts, its executive secretary Wisdom Kwaku Deku said, reported on 17 September 2026. It will be phased in. He said enforcement against accepting card photocopies instead of verification starts on 2 November 2026.

DVLAVERIFY BIOMETRIC IDENTITY VERIFICATION

- **DVLAverify app now available on iOS as DVLA introduces web verification platform** — MyJoyOnline, 23 September 2026

  Ghana's Driver and Vehicle Licensing Authority released its DVLAverify biometric identity-verification app on Apple's App Store and opened a web version usable from any computer with a webcam. Vehicle-registration applicants can now complete identity checks remotely.

ELECTRONIC NUMBER PLATE SYSTEM (DVLA)

- **DVLA begins pilot of RFID-enabled number plates ahead of 2027 rollout** — MyJoyOnline, 29 September 2026

  Ghana's vehicle licensing authority began piloting RFID-enabled number plates ahead of issuance to newly registered vehicles from January 2027. How existing vehicles will be re-registered is still to be announced.

GHANA CARD AS A TRAVEL DOCUMENT

- **ECOWAS pushes biometric ID toward region-wide border acceptance by December** — Biometric Update, 5 October 2026 WEST AFRICA

  ECOWAS is running public campaigns in Ghana and Nigeria ahead of its December 2026 target for all member states to accept its biometric identity card at air, land and sea borders. Seven member states have issued the card so far.

GHANA CARD ENROLMENT FOR CHILDREN AGED 6 TO 14

- **NIA extends Ghana Card registration for children in North East and Upper East** — MyJoyOnline, 5 October 2026

  Ghana's National Identification Authority, with the National Health Insurance Authority, began school-based Ghana Card registration of children aged 6 to 14 in the North East and Upper East regions on 5 October 2026. Children need a birth certificate, passport or citizenship certificate, or an oath of identity by a parent or guardian; those registered in the 2024 pilot should not re-register.

GHANA CARD

- **NIA biometric system to tighten fraud controls** — GhanaWeb, 9 October 2026

  Ghana's National Identification Authority will begin Ghana Card registration of children aged 0-5 the following week, alongside the ongoing registration of 6-14 year olds, its deputy executive secretary Fred Bedzrah said at a forum at the University of Professional Studies, Accra. He presented biometric verification with liveness detection as the check against ghost names on government payrolls.

Kenya

REMOVAL OF EXTRA ID VETTING IN BORDER COUNTIES

- **600,000 secure IDs after government drops extra vetting in border counties** — Radio Generation Kenya, 17 September 2026

  Kenya's National Registration Bureau said more than 600,000 people who previously could not obtain identity cards have been registered since extra vetting in border counties was dropped after President William Ruto's announcement in Wajir on 5 February 2025. Bureau secretary Gilbert Kitiyo said registration continues and first-time applications and replacements are free.

- **End ID vetting for good, rights groups urge government** — The Star, 17 September 2026

  Five Kenyan rights groups, including the Nubian Rights Forum and Haki na Sheria Initiative, urged the government to write the abolition of identity card vetting into law before the 2027 election, rather than relying on a presidential directive. They want discretionary review powers removed and free document verification for applicants who prove name, age and citizenship.

DIGITAL BIRTH-NOTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **Kenya's digital birth registration platform enrols 270k newborns in two months** — Biometric Update, 21 September 2026

  Kenya's electronic birth notification system, launched in June 2026, registered more than 270,000 newborns and gave them unique personal identifiers within two months. It sends birth details from hospitals to civil registration offices. Principal Secretary Belio Kipsang said 2.4 million national IDs were issued from January to September 2026, and an e-notification system for deaths is planned.

- **State to Expand Digital Birth Registration to SHA Hospitals Within 3 Months** — Kenyans.co.ke, 6 October 2026

  Kenya will extend electronic birth notification to every hospital contracted by the Social Health Authority within three months, by December 2026, the immigration principal secretary said. Newborns notified this way receive a Unique Personal Identifier, and talks with the health ministry on linking civil registration to hospital systems are complete.

- **Kenya to introduce electronic birth notifications in three counties from Mashujaa Day** — TechTrendsKE, 14 October 2026

  Kenya's Interior Cabinet Secretary, Kipchumba Murkomen, announced that electronic birth notification will be piloted in Nandi, Uasin Gishu and Elgeyo Marakwet counties from Mashujaa Day, 20 October 2026, sending birth records from health facilities straight to civil registration. The Immigration principal secretary said it will reach all hospitals covered by the Social Health Authority within three months.

DIGITAL LIVE CAPTURE DEVICES FOR IDENTITY ISSUANCE

- **Bungoma ID registration hampered by staff, vehicle and equipment shortages** — Vivid Voice News, 3 October 2026

  Kenya's National Assembly committee on administration and internal security inspected registration offices in Bungoma County on 2 October 2026 and heard that ID and civil registration are held back by shortages of staff, vehicles, equipment and office space. The county has two ageing vehicles. It recorded 19,361 registrations between July and September 2026.

- **Parliament probes delays in issuance of IDs, birth certificates in Elgeyo Marakwet** — People Daily, 5 October 2026

  Kenya's National Assembly committee on administration and internal security heard on 5 October 2026 that national ID cards in Elgeyo Marakwet County take one to two months to issue against a two-week standard. Officials blamed processing in Nairobi, poor connectivity, too few staff and vehicles, and some sub-counties receiving as little as Sh10,000 for fuel a quarter.

Liberia

NATIONAL IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM CONCESSION

- **Liberia: NIR: US$54.7M Digital ID Deal Awaits Legislative Approval** — FrontPage Africa, 8 September 2026

  Liberia's US$54.7 million concession with Austria's OeSD International to rebuild the national identification system has been signed but cannot be implemented until the legislature ratifies it, National Identification Registry director Andrew Peters said. The project covers biometric enrolment and deduplication, digital and physical credentials and a digital identity platform. No signature date is given.

- **Liberia to link national ID, CRVS in planned infrastructure upgrade** — Biometric Update, 14 September 2026

  Liberia's identification registry plans one system linking national ID with civil registration and vital statistics under its proposed US$54 million partnership with Austria's OSD. The signed agreement still needs parliamentary approval, and ID issuance has been suspended since June 2025.

- **Liberia: Free National ID Cards Only for Disadvantaged Liberians - Says National Identification Registry** — allAfrica.com, 17 September 2026

  Liberia's National Identification Registry said on 15 September 2026 that free national ID cards will go only to disadvantaged and unemployed citizens, with employed Liberians and foreign residents paying a fee. It is seeking about US$54.7m for the programme, which starts once an agreement before the legislature is ratified. Its director said the financier, OSD, will invest in ICT infrastructure while the registry keeps custody of personal data.

- **NIR Seeks Legislative Approval for US$54.7M Identity Deal - Liberia news The New Dawn Liberia, premier resource for latest news** — Liberia news The New Dawn Liberia, premier resource for latest news, 17 September 2026

Liberia's National Identification Registry asked the legislature on 16 September 2026 to speed ratification of a US$54.7 million identity deal with OeSD International. Under the build, operate and transfer arrangement OeSD would fund biometric enrolment and infrastructure, run it to recover the investment, then hand it to government. No signature date is given.

- **House Begins Review of Boakai's Proposed National Digital ID Overhaul** — Liberian Observer, 16 October 2026

  Liberia's House of Representatives referred President Boakai's proposed concession with OeSD International for a combined national ID and civil registration system to a joint committee, with 14 days to report; the referral is not ratification. Under the build-operate-transfer deal, OeSD would build and run a system issuing biometric ID numbers and cards and recording births, deaths and marriages, then hand it to the government.

- **House Scrutinizes US$52M National ID Deal** — The New Dawn, 16 October 2026

  Liberia's House of Representatives has sent a proposed US$52 million concession with OeSD International for a national ID and digital civil registry to a joint committee, which has two weeks to report. This account dates the President's communication to plenary on 15 October 2026 and says the build-operate-transfer system would hold demographic and biometric data on up to 10 million people.

- **Liberia: Naymote Urges Legislature to Tighten US$52M National ID Deal, Cites Cost, Electoral and Data Protection Concerns** — FrontPage Africa, 16 October 2026

  Liberian civil society group Naymote, in a statement of 15 October 2026, urged the Legislature to tighten the proposed national ID agreement, which it values at US$52 million. It asks for full disclosure of financing, fees and contract terms, an independent value-for-money review, government ownership of identity data, free first-time enrolment and public hearings, and says the electoral commission must keep control of the voters' roll.

- **Liberian Senate Orders Review of US$52 Million Digital Identity Concession Agreement - Liberia Public Radio** — Liberia Public Radio, 16 October 2026

  Liberia's Senate sent President Boakai's proposed US$52 million build-operate-transfer concession with Germany's OeSD International for a national ID, civil registry and vital statistics system (NIDCRVS) to three committees. They are to report to plenary within two weeks, before any vote on ratification.

- **Liberian MPs begin scrutinizing PPP concession deal for new national ID** — Biometric Update, 19 October 2026

  Liberia's House of Representatives referred a proposed $52 million build-operate-transfer concession for a national ID and civil registration system to a joint committee on 16 October 2026, giving it two weeks to report. The system would hold records for up to 10 million people, and civil society groups are asking for scrutiny of the financial terms and data protection. The National Identification Registry says fewer than 800,000 people hold a national ID.

NATIONAL IDENTITY ENROLMENT

- **Liberia: President Boakai Declares Wednesday, September 16, as "National Identification Day** — APO Group - Africa Newsroom, 16 September 2026

  Liberia's President Joseph Nyuma Boakai declared 16 September 2026 National Identification Day, a working holiday, by proclamation. The proclamation states that about 720,000 people are enrolled in the National Biometric Identification System, run by the National Identification Registry set up by law in 2011, and that every person in Liberia is required to enrol.

Libya

CIVIL-REGISTRY FRAUD ENFORCEMENT

- **إيقاف 3090 رقما وطنيا مزورا وإحالة متهمين للتحقيق** — ليبيا الأحرار, 10 September 2026

  Libya's Public Prosecutor halted 3,090 national identification numbers issued on forged civil-status data at the Majdul civil registry office, where investigators found failures in managing family records. The numbers had been used to obtain documents claiming citizenship rights. One suspect was remanded in custody and arrest orders were issued for others, within the jurisdiction of the Sebha Court of Appeal.

- **ظاهرة الأرقام الوطنية المزورة تتفاقم.. كيف نسد ثغرات السجل المدني الليبي؟** — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 27 September 2026

  Libya's public prosecutor announced another case of civil-status records falsified for money, reviving concern over forged national identity numbers, which the last official tally put above 89,000. The report traces the problem to 2022, when forged numbers were found to have drawn salaries and family grants, and asks how the civil registry's gaps can be closed.

- **النائب العام يكشف تزوير 315 ألف رقم وطني وتجميد رواتب ومعاشات مرتبطة بها** — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 13 October 2026

  Libya's Attorney General, Al-Siddiq Al-Sour, said on 13 October 2026 that a data review found more than 315,000 National Numbers issued unlawfully and over 10,000 passports issued on forged data. Authorities suspended 8,662 National Numbers, recalled 1,855 passports and froze LYD 84.5m in salaries and pensions. He also reported mismatches between the civil registry, National Number and voter databases.

ELECTRONIC PASSPORT ISSUANCE

- **النيابة العامة تكشف استخراج 10 آلاف جواز سفر ببيانات مزورة في ليبيا** — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 15 October 2026

  Libya's public prosecutor said 10,190 passports had been issued on forged civil-registry data. The passport and civil-registry databases are now linked to prosecutors, and five million secured registry forms have been sent to 365 offices.

Madagascar

IZAHO TOKANA 2.0 MASS BIOMETRIC REGISTRATION

- **Enregistrement biométrique – « Izaho tokana 2.0 » entre dans sa deuxième phase** — Moov Madagascar, 17 September 2026

  Madagascar's interior minister launched the second phase of the Izaho tokana 2.0 identity programme, mass biometric enrolment with a unique identification number for each person, at Anosy on 16 September 2026, National Identity Day. The World Bank funds the operation through the DECIM project, and an operational command centre for enrolment was opened. No enrolment targets or costs are given.

- **IDENTITÉ NUMÉRIQUE – « Izaho tokana 2.0 » cible plus de 10 millions de citoyens pour sa deuxième phase** — 2424.mg, 17 September 2026

  Madagascar's interior ministry launched the second phase of its biometric enrolment operation, Izaho tokana 2.0, on national identity day, aiming to register more than 10 million adults by July 2027. Nearly 5 million people were enrolled in the first phase from April to June 2026, against a target of 2 million, and 1,000 more enrolment kits have been added.

PRODIGY BIOMETRIC NATIONAL IDENTITY ENROLMENT

- **État civil : L'OIF aux côtés de Madagascar pour la Journée Nationale de l'Identité** — Midi Madagasikara, 17 September 2026

  Madagascar's National Identity Day, institutionalised by a 2024 decree, carried a high-level conference of more than 150 people preparing the 2027-2036 civil-registration decade. Phase II of the biometric enrolment operation was launched on the second day under the World Bank's digital connectivity project, with no target or coverage figure given for it.

Malawi

NZIKA WALLET MOBILE DIGITAL ID

- **Public Statement: Launch of Nzika Digital ID Wallet** — National Registration Bureau (Malawi), 8 September 2026

  Malawi's National Registration Bureau announced that it would launch the Nzika Digital ID Wallet on 16 September 2026 at the Bingu International Convention Centre in Lilongwe, with Homeland Security Minister Peter Mukhito presiding. The bureau says the wallet adds a digital ID to the physical card and will cut printing costs and the time taken to obtain an ID.

- **Malawi set to introduce digital ID wallet** — Malawi24, 10 September 2026

  Malawi's national registration bureau is to introduce a digital identity wallet, giving citizens a digital version of their national identity alongside the existing physical card. It is presented as an additional way of presenting and accessing identification as use of digital services grows.

- **Malawi takes national IDs digital with Nzika wallet** — Channel Africa, 11 September 2026

  Malawi's National Registration Bureau is launching the Nzika wallet on 16 September, an app holding a digital national ID, birth certificate and marriage certificate, downloadable from Google Play and the App Store. Its spokesman, Norman Fulatira, said physical ID cards, held by more than 9 million registered citizens, stay valid because smartphone and internet access remain limited.

- **Malawi to launch digital ID wallet as national ID coverage reaches 99%** — Biometric Update, 11 September 2026

  Malawi's National Registration Bureau announced the Nzika Digital ID Wallet, to launch on 16 September 2026, which will hold a digital copy of the national ID card with the same validity as the physical card. The bureau says 99% of citizens hold a national ID and more than 13.5 million people are enrolled; it expects the wallet to cut card-printing costs.

- **Malawi launches Nzika Digital ID Wallet and removes expiry date from National ID** — UNDP Malawi, 16 September 2026

  Malawi launched the Nzika Digital ID Wallet in Lilongwe on 16 September 2026 and from the same day removed the expiry date from national identity cards. The wallet, built by the National Registration Bureau with UNDP and funded by the EU, Ireland and Norway, holds national IDs and birth, marriage and death certificates. Homeland Security minister Peter Mukhito said it complements the physical card.

- **Digital gap challenges Nzika ID rollout** — Malawi24, 17 September 2026

  Malawi's ICT minister put smartphone ownership at 33 per cent and basic internet skills at 12.5 per cent, saying the gaps could hinder adoption of the digital identity wallet launched the same week in Lilongwe. He called for collaboration between the private sector, civil society and academia to close them.

- **National IDs to last a lifetime** — Nation Online, 17 September 2026

  Malawi's homeland security minister Peter Mukhito announced at the launch of the Nzika Digital ID wallet in Lilongwe that national identity cards will no longer expire, with verification by real-time biometrics against the registration bureau's database. He said 6.6 million children are in the civil registration system, with 3.4 million more targeted by year-end; a cybersecurity expert urged strict limits on data shared with providers.

BIOMETRIC LOAN BONDING AGAINST THE NATIONAL REGISTER

- **HESLGB adopts biometric verification linked to NRB** — Malawi24, 17 September 2026

  Malawi's higher education loans and grants board has moved loan-contract bonding onto a paperless process in which students present the national identity card and scan fingerprints on a device linked to the registration bureau's database, which matches the details before bonding completes. The board's stated reason is cost; the 2026/2027 exercise began on 7 September and has so far covered campuses of three universities.

NZIKA DIGITAL ID WALLET

- **Malawi drops ID card expiry date policy as digital wallet launches** — Biometric Update, 18 September 2026

  Malawi launched the Nzika digital ID wallet on International Identity Day, holding national ID, birth, marriage and death credentials on a phone as an optional complement to the physical card. The homeland security minister also ended expiry dates on the biometric ID card with immediate effect.

BIOMETRIC REGISTRATION KIT SUPPLY CONTRACT

- **Nzika Wallet controversy! Who holds the keys to Malawi's multibillion digital identity?** — Malawi24, 26 September 2026

  A Malawi24 investigation reports that a Hong Kong-registered company won a US$5.09 million World Bank-financed contract in March 2026 to supply 2,400 biometric registration kits to the National Registration Bureau, with remote software support. The procurement authority says remote access reaches the kits only; the bureau, the communications regulator and the supplier did not say who else can reach the identity system.

E-KYC AND DIGITAL IDENTITY PROJECT

- **India, UN agencies review e-KYC and Digital Identity Project in Malawi** — IANS, 29 September 2026

  India's High Commissioner to Malawi, Amararam Gujar, met a UNDP and UNCDF delegation on 29 September 2026 to review the e-KYC and Digital Identity Project in Malawi, funded through the India-UN Development Partnership Fund and implemented with partners including the Reserve Bank of Malawi. They discussed its achievements, findings and transition. No funding figure for the project is given.

POINT-OF-CARE DIGITAL BIRTH REGISTRATION

- **Printers to bring registration services closer to Malawians** — Malawi24, 9 October 2026

  UNDP handed Malawi 152 printers to bring birth, marriage and death registration closer to people: 100 for registration offices at Traditional Authority level and 52 for health facilities. The minister said 180 health facilities are already digitalised.

- **UNDP hands over 152 printers to National Registration Bureau to expand civil registration** — United Nations Development Programme, 10 October 2026

  UNDP's own account of the 152 printers handed to Malawi's registration bureau: 100 for registration at Traditional Authority offices and 52 for health facilities. It puts the Nzika registration application in pilot at 87 locations in five districts, with 250 planned by 2028.

Mauritius

DIGITAL DRIVING LICENCE ON THE KOREK APP

- **MauPass et KOREK! : les citoyens accompagnés dans leurs démarches** — Le Defi Media Group, 2 October 2026

  Mauritius Digital Promotion Agency staff will help citizens register on MauPass and reach their digital driving licence in the KOREK app from the coming week. The 883,700 licence holders have three months before the digital licence takes legal effect on 1 January 2027.

- **Permis de conduire numérique : Le compte à rebours est lancé** — L'Express (Maurice), 3 October 2026

  Mauritius's digital driving licence takes legal effect on 1 January 2027, after a transition period that began on 29 September. A driver may show either the digital licence on the KOREK app or the original physical licence, and the ICT minister said 500,000 people have registered on MauPass, the account needed to reach it.

Namibia

NATIONAL ELECTRONIC IDENTITY CARD

- **Government briefs lawmakers on new digital e-ID card** — Namibia Economist, 6 October 2026

  Namibia's home affairs and ICT ministries briefed members of parliament on the rollout of a new electronic identity card. MPs asked about system security, cyberattacks, backups and who owns and controls the technology where private providers are involved, and about a proposed Resident Identity Card for long-term foreign residents. The briefing date is not given.

- **Namibia MPs press government on security, access and reach of planned digital ID | Biometric Update** — Biometric Update, 8 October 2026

  Namibian MPs questioned the planned digital ID on rural reach, cost, data ownership and cybersecurity at a briefing by two ministries. The rollout planned for September was delayed because the legal framework had not been finalised.

Niger

AGENCE NATIONALE DE L'ENREGISTREMENT ET DE L'IDENTIFICATION DES PERSONNES PHYSIQUES

- **Diffa : lancement de la tournee nationale de sensibilisation sur la modernisation de l''etat civil et l''identification** — Agence Nigerienne de Presse (ANP), 3 September 2026

  Niger opened a national awareness tour on civil registration, identification and the modernisation of the national identification system at Diffa on 3 September 2026. The opening workshop, chaired by the regional secretary-general, briefed institutional and community actors on reforms carried out under the World Bank-supported WURI-Niger unique identification project.

AES BIOMETRIC PASSPORT

- **Niger : l'enrôlement pour le passeport biométrique AES débute le 15 septembre 2026** — NigerDiaspora, 9 September 2026

  Niger's interior ministry said mass enrolment for the Alliance of Sahel States biometric passport opens on 15 September 2026, at the territorial surveillance directorate in Niamey and regional police offices elsewhere. The passport costs 45,000 FCFA, or 29,750 FCFA for minors and students. Passports bearing the ECOWAS logo stay valid until they expire.

- **From ECOWAS to AES: Niger Completes Its Passport Break with the Regional Bloc** — ModernGhana, 11 September 2026

  Niger launched its own biometric passport, with President Abdourahamane Tiani enrolled first, making it the last of the three Alliance of Sahel States members to replace the ECOWAS passport. The system has five categories, including a hajj passport, and the Libyan firm Al Itissan Al-Jadeed is involved in production. Existing ECOWAS passports remain valid.

- **Lancement officiel du passeport biométrique AES : le Niger se dote d'un nouveau document de voyage aux normes internationales** — ActuNiger, 16 September 2026

  Niger opened mass enrolment for the Sahel confederation's biometric passport in Niamey on 15 September 2026, with enrolment kits to go to every region and the diaspora. An ordinary passport costs 45,000 FCFA and runs five years, with online pre-enrolment through mobile money services.

AES BIOMETRIC NATIONAL IDENTITY CARD

- **CNIB AES à Agadez : Tarifs, pièces et enrôlement** — Journal du Niger, 15 September 2026

  Enrolment for the regional bloc's biometric national identity card opened in Agadez at the regional police headquarters, fingerprints and biometric parameters collected locally and processed centrally.

AES BIOMETRIC PASSPORT

- **Niger begins operational rollout of AES biometric passport** — Biometric Update, 18 September 2026

  Niger opened public enrolment for the Alliance of Sahel States biometric passport in Niamey on 15 September, with regional and diaspora centres and online pre-enrolment through mobile money to follow. An ordinary passport costs FCFA 45,000; Niger is the last of the three states to issue it.

Nigeria

LAGOS RESIDENTS REGISTRATION NUMBER REQUIRED FOR SCHOOL ENROLMENT

- **2026/27 Session: Lagos makes LASRRA number compulsory for school admission** — Vanguard, 4 September 2026

  Lagos State made the Lagos State Residents Registration Agency (LASRRA) number mandatory for admission and enrolment in all public and private schools from the 2026/27 session, with schools required to record it from 14 September 2026. The education commissioner, Tolani Alli-Balogun, said the aim is a verifiable database of learners.

ADMISSIONS BOARD AND ELECTORAL COMMISSION BIOMETRIC SHARING

- **JAMB, INEC Seek Collaboration on Use of Biometric Technology** — Voice of Nigeria, 5 September 2026

  The registrar of Nigeria's Joint Admissions and Matriculation Board, Segun Aina, asked the electoral commission (INEC) during a visit to its Abuja headquarters to lend some of its biometric verification machines for use in JAMB examinations, reported on 5 September 2026. INEC chairman Joash Amupitan told his ICT director to assess the availability, condition and suitability of the equipment.

NATIONAL IDENTIFICATION NUMBER AND THE FOUNDATIONAL IDENTITY REGISTER

- **Nigeria needs 62.5 million more NINs in six months to meet target** — TechCabal, 7 September 2026

Nigeria had issued national identification numbers to 117.5 million people out of 134.6 million enrolments at 30 June 2026, against a target of 180 million by December. Closing the gap would need monthly enrolment to rise from 1.5–1.8 million to about 7.4 million.

- **FG Sets December Deadline for 95% NIN Coverage** — ThisDay, 16 September 2026

  Nigeria's government set December 2026 as the deadline for 95% national identity number coverage, announced on National Identity Day. Officials put the database at close to 140 million and said physical e-ID cards will be issued before the end of the year.

NIMC INVESTIGATION OF LICENSED TOKENISATION VERIFICATION AGENTS

- **NIMC Assures Nigerians of Safety of Identity Data** — ThisDay, 23 September 2026

  Nigeria's National Identity Management Commission denied claims in a social-media video that NIN and other personal data had been breached and put up for sale. Its director-general ordered an investigation into whether any tokenisation verification agents breached their licences; no findings or timeline were given.

NINAUTH CONSENT-BASED VERIFICATION

- **NIMC's NINAuth Mandate and Nigeria's 180M NIN Push** — Techmoonshot, 5 October 2026

  Nigeria's President Bola Tinubu has ordered every ministry, department and agency to use the identity commission's NINAuth service as its default identity check. NIMC says enrolment has passed 136 million against a year-end target of 180 million, while its fee for correcting a date of birth rose from ₦16,340 to ₦28,574.

NATIONAL COOPERATIVE DIGITAL IDENTITY

- **Cooperative Digitalisation: FG Reaffirms Commitment Towards National Cooperative Identity Reform Under RH – CRRP 2030, Tasks States On Implementation - Federal Ministry of Information and National Orientation** — Federal Ministry of Information and National Orientation, 7 October 2026

  Nigeria's supervising minister of cooperative affairs, Aliyu Sabi Abdullahi, told the National Cooperative Summit in Abuja on 7 October 2026 that the National Cooperative Identity Reform has begun at no cost to federal or state governments. It is to provide a national register, a verifiable number and a CoopID for more than 370,000 cooperatives with over 30 million members, under an August 2026 agreement with the Cooperative Federation of Nigeria and Seamfix.

KATSINA STATE IDENTITY SYSTEM INTEGRATION WITH THE NATIONAL IDENTITY ARCHITECTURE

- **Gov Radda Seeks NIMC Partnership to Strengthen Identity Management** — Time Express Nigeria, 10 October 2026

  Katsina State and Nigeria's identity commission agreed a working group to link the state's identity management system to the national one, with a framework and memorandum due within eight weeks.

ADMISSIONS BOARD NIN ALIGNMENT SERVICE

- **JAMB Moves to Rescue Graduates Stuck for Years over NIN Data Mismatch, Unveils New Service** — ThisDay, 18 October 2026

  Nigeria's admissions board launched a service that lets candidates correct their records to match their national identity data. It is meant to help graduates who have been barred from national service for years by mismatched records.

Rwanda

DIGITAL IDENTITY ENROLMENT

- **Over 10 million Rwandans registered for digital ID** — Umunota, 16 September 2026

  Rwanda's National Identification Agency said on 16 September 2026 that it has captured photographs and biometrics, including fingerprints and iris scans, for more than 10 million people in 27 of the country's 30 districts, as registration opened in Rusizi District. The digital ID, launched in 2023 with the World Bank at a cost of about Rwf200 billion, offers a physical card, a QR-code version and a separate token.

- **NIDA temporarily suspends photography exercise for e-IDs** — Ukweli Times, 8 October 2026

  Rwanda's identification agency suspended the photography exercise for the digital identity card and gave no date for resuming it. Pre-enrolment through Irembo continues, and residents are asked to correct civil-registration details first.

Senegal

CIVIL-STATUS SOFTWARE DEPLOYMENT ACROSS CENTRES

- **Etat civil : 77 % des centres couverts par le processus de modernisation (DG ANEC) - APS** — Agence de Presse Senegalaise, 17 September 2026

  Senegal's civil registration agency ANEC said on 16 September 2026 that 77% of the country's 629 civil registry centres are covered by its modernisation programme, with Tambacounda next and the southern regions in the last quarter. Director-general Matar Ndao said records are held in three state data centres in Senegal and that maternity units can now register births directly in ANEC's system.

EXAM CANDIDATES WITHOUT A CIVIL-STATUS RECORD

- **Etat civil : 58 462 enfants sans acte au CFEE, l'alerte de l'ONPEC** — Seneweb, 23 September 2026

  Senegal's first national forum on civil registration opened in Dakar on 23 September 2026. The National Organisation for the Promotion of Civil Registration (ONPEC) said 58,462 children sat the CFEE primary exam without a birth record, with 7,823 at the BFEM and 98 at the baccalaureate; the exam year is not stated. A report to the authorities is to follow.

Sierra Leone

NATIONAL IDENTITY CARD ISSUANCE

- **Government Must Act on Tripartite Recommendation 15: Make National Identity Cards Affordable for Sierra Leoneans | OWLPRESS** — Owlpress, 15 October 2026

  Sierra Leone MP Alpha Ben Mansaray, deputy parliamentary spokesman, asked the government on 15 October 2026 to implement the Tripartite Committee's recommendation 15 and subsidise national identity cards. The NCRA raised the standard card fee from NLe 145 to NLe 165 in February 2026; he proposes NLe 50, which he states is his own figure, not policy.

Somalia

PROPOSED NATIONAL ID REQUIREMENT FOR SOCIAL MEDIA ACCOUNTS

- **The Ministry of Information Wants a Name Behind Every Somali Account** — The Somali Digest, 9 September 2026

Somalia's deputy prime minister, Jibril Abdirashid Abdi, asked the information ministry on 7 September 2026 to require social media accounts to carry the holder's NIRA identity number in the media regulations being drafted. He spoke at a communication forum in Mogadishu; the report also records dozens of disputed takedowns of Puntland broadcasters' posts between January and August.

- **Opinion: My Reflections on the Strategic and Communication Forum 2026** — Dawan Africa, 11 September 2026

  An opinion piece on Somalia's Strategic and Communication Forum 2026 in Mogadishu, organised by the information ministry, notes that Deputy Prime Minister Jibril Abdi Rashid Haji Abdi proposed requiring NIRA national identification to open accounts, citing security and misinformation. The author calls for the proposal to be weighed against privacy and free expression, and for a mechanism to follow up the forum's recommendations.

BIOMETRIC PASSPORT AND TRAVEL-DATA EXCHANGE

- **Somali immigration agency, AU discuss border security and counterterrorism cooperation** — Hiiraan Online, 16 September 2026

  Somalia's Immigration and Citizenship Agency met the African Union Counter Terrorism Centre in Mogadishu on 16 September 2026 to discuss border security and the exchange of security and travel information. The agency briefed the delegation on its digital systems for migration data and document verification, including biometric passports and an e-Visa system. No agreement was reported.

NATIONAL ID REQUIREMENT FOR SIM CARDS

- **National Identification Week 2026 Concludes in Mogadishu** — SONNA, 19 September 2026

  Somalia's National Identification Week closed in Mogadishu, reported on 19 September 2026. The National Identification and Registration Authority said it has registered 1.5 million citizens through 59 registration centres, 17 mobile teams and 31 centres at embassies.

NATIONAL IDENTITY ENROLMENT

- **Somalia registers 1.5 million citizens under national ID system** — Hiiraan Online, 20 September 2026

  Somalia's identity authority has registered more than 1.5 million citizens since 2023, against a target of 15 million citizens and residents by 2029. The interior minister said issuance would extend to embassies abroad, with priority for persons with disabilities and displaced communities.

NATIONAL IDENTITY REQUIREMENT FOR DOMESTIC TRAVEL

- **Puntland passengers blocked from flights over NIRA ID requirement** — Hiiraan Online, 1 October 2026

  Somalia's federal government began enforcing a requirement on 1 October 2026 that domestic travellers carry the NIRA national identity card. Passengers at Garowe in Puntland, where the identification authority has no registration offices and the card is not issued, were refused boarding on flights to Mogadishu and Nairobi.

NATIONAL IDENTITY INTEGRATION WITH THE HALMEEL PUBLIC SERVICE CENTRE

- **Somalia Moves to Link National ID with Public Services** — Goobjoog News, 6 October 2026

  Somalia's identity authority is moving to link its registration services to HALMEEL, the national unified public service delivery centre, where an area has been set aside for it. The aim is one national identity across several government services; the integration is planned and not yet in place.

- **Somalia plans unified digital government platform built around national ID** — Biometric Update, 19 October 2026

  Somalia's Unified Public Service Delivery Center, known as Halmeel, plans to launch a unified digital government services platform by the end of March 2027, starting with about 70 services. The national ID will be the only accepted credential, its director general told Biometric Update. Halmeel, created by Cabinet resolution on 23 April, is integrating with the national ID agency NIRA, which had about 2 million people registered as of October 2026.

South Africa

INVESTIGATION INTO VISA ADJUDICATION WITHOUT VERIFICATION

- **Home Affairs officials 'paid to ignore' fraudulent visa documents** — IOL / The Star, 4 September 2026

  South Africa's Special Investigating Unit found Home Affairs adjudicators took kickbacks to approve visas on fraudulent supporting documents without conducting any verification. It has flagged 205 visas for revocation and deportation with seven disciplinary referrals, under a 2024 proclamation covering almost two decades of visa administration, and recommends reducing human intervention through technology and integrating departmental systems so verifications run automatically.

STATE PUBLIC KEY INFRASTRUCTURE FOR DIGITAL IDENTITY

- **South Africa is behind its neighbours on the plumbing of digital IDs** — TechCentral, 11 September 2026

  Zambia's ICT regulator ZICTA completed a key ceremony establishing a national root certification authority, eight days after Namibia's regulator CRAN launched its DigiNam public key infrastructure on 31 August 2026. South Africa has no state system deployed; three private providers are accredited, and Home Affairs plans infrastructure hosted at SARS by 31 March 2027 and roll-out in 2027/28.

NATIONAL DIGITAL IDENTITY (CREDENTIAL AND WALLET)

- **End of the line: Here's when the old SA green ID book will be discontinued** — The Citizen (South Africa), 1 October 2026

  South Africa's home affairs minister said production of the green ID book will end on 31 March 2027. He showed the first working digital identity credential and put smart ID replacements at more than 515 bank branches and 822,000 users.

- **SA: Dr Leon Schreiber: Address by Minister of Home Affairs, at the Home Affairs Quantum Leap: A Vision for the Future of Government at Constitution Hill (01/10/2026)** — Polity, 2 October 2026

  South Africa's Home Affairs Minister Leon Schreiber announced at Constitution Hill on 1 October 2026 that the department will stop producing the green ID book by 31 March 2027, and that it will cease to be valid identification on 31 March 2028. The 14.7 million people who hold only a green ID book will have 12 months after production ends to switch to the Smart ID card.

ELECTRONIC TRAVEL AUTHORISATION

- **Machine learning gets first say on who gets into SA** — ITWeb South Africa, 2 October 2026

  South Africa's home affairs department said its Electronic Travel Authorisation uses machine learning to make automated, risk-based decisions on short-stay visa applications, with a human brought in where the system flags an anomaly. The system is live at four airports.

ROAD TRAFFIC REGULATIONS AMENDMENT ON ACCEPTABLE IDENTIFICATION

- **Proposed changes to Traffic Regulations to affect South Africans and foreigners** — The Citizen (South Africa), 10 October 2026

  South Africa's Department of Transport plans to amend the National Road Traffic Regulations so that Traffic Register Number certificates and learner's and driving licences can no longer be used as general identification. A 2023 check with Home Affairs of 1,072,258 TRNs found only 29,653 (2.7%) matched the national immigration identification system. The draft is to be published for 30 days' comment.

- **Department to scrap use of drivers' licences as ID** — eNCA, 11 October 2026

  South Africa's transport minister said 300,000 dormant traffic register numbers have been blocked, about half of those found to be fraudulent. Holders of the rest have been asked to verify their details with Home Affairs, and about 8,000 have come forward.

- **Government to amend regulations to prevent traffic documents being used as identification** — SAnews (South African Government News Agency), 11 October 2026

  South Africa's transport department plans to amend the road traffic regulations so that traffic register number certificates, learner's licences and driving licences no longer count as identification. A traffic register number would be valid only as long as the passport and permit it was issued on, and the draft is to be gazetted for 30 days of comment.

Sudan

SUDAPASS (NATIONAL DIGITAL IDENTITY)

- **بنك أم درمان الوطني أول بنك يتيح تحديث بيانات العملاء رقمياً باستخدام سوداباس** — Sudan News Agency (SUNA), 26 September 2026

  Omdurman National Bank became the first bank in Sudan to link to the national digital identity SudaPass on 26 September 2026, letting customers inside and outside the country update their data through its digital channels without visiting a branch. The digital transformation ministry and the Central Bank of Sudan are connecting other banks as each becomes technically ready.

SMART IDENTITY CARD ANNOUNCED BY THE TASIS-BACKED ADMINISTRATION

- **TASIS outlines governance plans for 24 million Sudanese** — The Sudan Times, 12 October 2026

  The prime minister of Sudan's TASIS-backed administration announced plans for a national smart identity card for banking, judicial and administrative transactions in the territory it runs, alongside new vehicle registration, licensing and customs procedures. He put that territory at about 90 localities and 24 million people, figures that are not independently verified.

Tanzania

LOCALLY HOSTED FRAUD, IDENTITY AND KNOW-YOUR-CUSTOMER CHECKS

- **Bank of Tanzania backs Creditinfo's locally operated fraud, identity solutions** — The Citizen, 7 September 2026

  Tanzania's central bank backed a credit bureau's locally operated fraud detection, identity verification and know-your-customer services for lenders.

PROCESSED IDENTITY CARDS UNCOLLECTED

- **Why your NIDA number is more than just a numeral** — The Citizen, 17 September 2026

Tanzania is piloting registration of children from birth in three districts, and 2,027,103 finished identity cards remain uncollected.

- **6,308 NIDA cards remain uncollected in Zanzibar** — The Guardian (IPP Media), 12 October 2026

  Tanzania's home affairs minister said 6,308 national identity cards printed for Zanzibar residents had not been collected. He said government is considering fines for late collection and may require the physical card for services that now accept the identity number alone.

SERVICES LINKED TO THE NATIONAL IDENTITY NUMBER

- **NIDA yako kuwa 'JAMII NAMBA', huduma 9 kuunganishwa** — Nipashe (IPP Media), 17 September 2026

  The director-general of Tanzania's National Identification Authority (NIDA), James Kaji, said in Dar es Salaam on 16 September 2026 that the national ID will be linked to nine services instead of the current four. Planned links include birth certificates, health insurance, taxpayer numbers, driving licences and blood group. No timetable or cost is given.

Togo

NATIONAL CITIZEN ACCOUNT OR SINGLE SIGN-ON

- **Suggestions au Ministère de la Sécurité — Service public de l'administration Togolaise** — République Togolaise — Service public de l'administration Togolaise, 4 September 2026

  Togo's national public-service portal offers a free procedure for anyone aged 18 or over, in Togo or in the diaspora, to submit suggestions to the Ministry of Security on security services, administrative procedures and civil protection. Each suggestion goes through an examination and decision step. The page carries no publication date and covers one ministry only.

FREE NATIONALITY CERTIFICATES FOR SCHOOLGIRLS

- **Citoyenneté : 4200 élèves filles bientôt dotées de certificats de nationalité** — République Togolaise, 14 September 2026

  Togo began issuing free nationality certificates to 4,200 schoolgirls, 600 in each of seven education regions, with the first 300 final-year pupils served in Grand Lomé. The online nationality certificate platform launched in 2024 has received 241,617 applications and processed 179,690, or 74%; officials blame delays on documents from prefectures and intermediaries withholding SMS notices.

NUMERO D'IDENTIFICATION UNIQUE AND THE BIOMETRIC IDENTITY CARD

- **e-ID Togo : plus de 6 millions de personnes enregistrées, la région de la Kara prochaine étape** — Levisionnaire, 28 September 2026

  Togo's identity agency closed biometric enrolment in the Centrale region with more than six million people registered and about 5.9 million cards produced, nearly 80% of them distributed. Kara, the last region, follows from October to December 2026.

Tunisia

E-HOUWIYA MOBILE IDENTITY

- **Numérisation : Le ministère de l'Agriculture intègre l'identité numérique « E-Houwiya » d'ici novembre 2026** — Tunisie-Tribune, 18 September 2026

Tunisia's agriculture ministry issued a circular requiring every body under it to integrate the E-Houwiya digital identity into its platforms by 15 November 2026. It makes the E-Houwiya identifier the sole reference for any new digital service and requires strong multi-factor authentication where extra checks apply.

NATIONAL HEALTH IDENTIFIER

- **Avec 180 000 Identifiants uniques, le CHU de Sahloul leader national en transition numérique - La Presse de Tunisie** — La Presse de Tunisie, 7 October 2026

  Tunisia's Sahloul university hospital in Sousse had unified 180,000 patient records under the unique health identifier by 6 October 2026, ranking it first among public hospitals in the roll-out, it said in a statement. A meeting chaired by its director general agreed a common method for handling outstanding technical cases.

Uganda

NATIONAL IDENTIFICATION NUMBER AND THE TAXPAYER NUMBER

- **What 'NIN Will Replace TIN in All Transactions' Actually Means** — Business Times Uganda, 1 September 2026

  Uganda's cabinet approved phasing out the standalone taxpayer identification number for individuals, replacing it with the national identification number already printed on the identity card. Nothing states a commencement date or a transition arrangement for the roughly nine to ten million Ugandans not yet on the register.

- **Transitioning from TIN to NIN will create jobs and open up formal markets** — New Vision, 16 September 2026

  Uganda's revenue authority said the taxpayer identification number will be phased out for individuals in favour of the national identification number, with companies using their registration number instead. It said the old system reached only just over 5 million taxpayers and that the change will remove duplicate and ghost records.

- **Government launches integration of National ID, tax identification systems** — NTV Uganda, 30 September 2026

  Uganda's internal affairs minister launched the integration of the national identification and tax identification systems at the country's first Identity Expo and Symposium in Kampala.

- **Linking NINs to Tax Records Will Tackle Identity Theft, Says URA** — Nile Post, 30 September 2026

  The Uganda Revenue Authority is moving to the National Identification Number as individuals' tax identifier, first mapping existing tax numbers to NINs, then taking fingerprint consent at URA service points. Basic biodata such as name, date of birth and photograph is drawn from the national identity authority's servers. Companies receive an entity number from the business registry, URSB.

- **More than 3mn tax records await NIN match before login switch** — Uganda Business News, 17 October 2026

  Uganda Revenue Authority had linked 2.13 million of its 5.41 million individual taxpayer records to National Identification Numbers by 30 September 2026, leaving about 3.27 million unmatched, the finance ministry told Parliament. Taxpayers with linked records are due to log in with their NIN from 1 January 2027, and no end date has been set for TIN logins.

PEOPLE ON THE NATIONAL REGISTER

- **NIRA register reaches 36.15 million people** — New Vision, 1 September 2026

  Uganda's identification authority holds 36.15 million people on the national register, close to 77% of a population the 2024 census put at 45.9 million, leaving nine to ten million unregistered. The figure matters because cabinet has just made that register the basis of tax identity.

TAX IDENTIFICATION NUMBER MERGED INTO THE NATIONAL ID NUMBER

- **ANDREW BABA: URA's TIN to NIN Migration, The Benefits and Risks of Uganda's New Tax Identity System** — Insight Post Uganda, 2 September 2026

  Analyst Andrew Baba reviews the Uganda Revenue Authority's move from the Tax Identification Number to the National Identification Number, run with the national registration authority NIRA. He says a single identifier should reduce duplicate tax identities and ease verification across government, but concentrates privacy, access and cybersecurity risks. No dates or figures for the migration are given.

NATIONAL SECURE IDENTIFICATION SYSTEM

- **NIRA on Spot as New National IDs Fail to Work for SIM Registration, Banks and Driving Permits** — Business Focus, 11 September 2026

  Uganda's new national identity cards cannot yet be used for SIM registration, banking or driving permits because partner institutions have not connected to the registration authority NIRA's data-exchange module, MPs heard on 9 September 2026. NIRA's director Rosemary Kisembo said the module began on 31 March 2026 and MTN was the first partner onboarded. The committee chair asked NIRA not to recall old IDs and to set activation timelines.

LOCAL PRINTING OF SECURE DOCUMENTS (UGANDA SECURITY PRINTING COMPANY)

- **Secure documents to be printed locally** — New Vision, 29 September 2026

  Uganda Security Printing Company said on 29 September 2026 that it will print the country's secure documents locally at a new factory, using security features supplied by the National Identification and Registration Authority for the national ID card. It named passports, driving permits, land titles, education certificates and ballot papers among its products. No start date or cost is given.

SHARE OF THE POPULATION IDENTIFIED

- **Identity is the Foundation of Security, Development, Says Minister Kamuntu as NIRA Expo Opens** — Nile Post, 29 September 2026

  Figures at the opening of Uganda's first national identity expo put about 36.2 million people identified, roughly 78.8% of the population. The internal affairs minister called on the registration authority to reach everyone.

Zambia

INVALIDATION OF THE NATIONAL IDENTITY DOCUMENTS OF GOVERNMENT CRITICS

- **Njapau Defends Invalidation Of IDs, Names HH's Online Attackers** — Lusaka Times, 19 September 2026

  Former Zambian deputy home affairs minister Grace Njapau defended the government's invalidation of national identity documents held by people she accused of an online campaign against President Hakainde Hichilema, naming Emmanuel Mwamba, JJ Banda, Sishuwa Sishuwa and Lillian Mutambo. The number affected, who among them is included and the legal process used are not stated; no government statement is cited.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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